

Veterans Backbone – Privacy & Data Protection Policy

Purpose

This policy sets out how Veterans Backbone collects, stores, uses, protects, and manages information.

It supports privacy, safeguarding, accountability, and legal compliance.

Scope

This policy applies to:

- Veterans and participants
 - Residents
 - Staff
 - Volunteers
 - Trustees
 - Contractors
 - External professionals
 - Visitors where applicable
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Information We May Hold

Information may include:

- Contact details
- Referral information
- Support records
- Safeguarding information
- Emergency contacts
- Employment and volunteer records
- Training records
- Governance and organisational records

Only information relevant to legitimate purposes should be collected.

Why We Collect Information

Information may be used to:

- Deliver services
- Manage support

- Protect safety and wellbeing
- Meet legal obligations
- Improve organisational effectiveness
- Monitor outcomes and impact

Information will not be collected without a legitimate purpose.

Storage & Security

Information must be:

- Stored securely
- Protected from unauthorised access
- Accessed only by authorised individuals
- Managed in accordance with organisational procedures

Appropriate technical and organisational safeguards must be maintained.

Information Sharing

Information may be shared where:

- Consent exists
- Safeguarding concerns exist
- Legal obligations require sharing
- Operational necessity exists

Information sharing should always be proportionate and justifiable.

Safeguarding Override

Confidentiality is important but not absolute.

Where a genuine safeguarding concern exists, information may be shared to prevent harm or protect safety.

Access To Information

Individuals may request access to information held about them, subject to applicable legal requirements.

Requests will be handled fairly and within appropriate timescales.

Data Accuracy

Reasonable steps should be taken to ensure information remains accurate, relevant, and up to date.

Errors should be corrected when identified.

Data Retention & Disposal

Information should only be retained for as long as necessary.

When no longer required, information should be disposed of securely and appropriately.

Data Breaches

Any actual or suspected data breach must be reported immediately.

Breaches will be reviewed, managed, and recorded appropriately.

Learning from incidents should be used to strengthen systems and reduce future risk.

Responsibilities

Everyone handling information is responsible for:

- Protecting confidentiality
- Following organisational procedures
- Reporting concerns promptly
- Maintaining professional standards

Information governance is a shared responsibility.

Review

This policy will be reviewed periodically and following significant incidents, legal changes, or organisational learning.

Final Statement

Veterans Backbone believes that trust is earned.

Responsible information handling is part of that trust.

We collect only what we need, protect what we hold, and use information in ways that support people rather than exploit them.